

Aside

Product Summary · textaside.app

What It Is

Aside is an SMS-first content saving app at textaside.app. Users text anything they want to save — links, notes, ideas, recipes, articles — to a Twilio phone number with #hashtags to organize them into boards. Everything is then accessible via a clean web dashboard.

"Text it, tag it, find it later."

Core Functionality

Saving Content

- **SMS saving** Text any message to the Aside number — saved instantly
- **Hashtag boards** Add #tags inline to auto-sort into private boards
- **MMS photos** Images stored in AWS S3 with signed URL retrieval
- **Instant search** Messages are searchable immediately after receipt

Boards

- **Private Boards** Auto-created from your hashtags, only visible to you — shows message count
- **Shared Boards** Invite others to collaborate; members receive SMS invite links
- **Real-time updates** WebSockets power live board changes across devices

AI-Powered Search

- **Web search** Conversational AI summary with typewriter animation above results
- **SMS search** Text "Hey Aside [query]" — receive results + link by reply
- **Intents** search · summarize · recommend · analyze · help
- **Search engine** Semantic vector search !' keyword-boosted reranking !' keyword fallback

Link Previews & Embeds

- **General URLs** Rich OG cards via Microlink
- **Instagram** Full iframe embeds
- **YouTube, Reddit, TikTok, Pinterest, X/Twitter, Facebook** Platform-native embeds
- **IMDB** Enhanced previews via TMDB API

Authentication

- **Phone number + SMS verification code** — no passwords required
- **Magic link authentication** support
- **Persistent session-based auth** with secure cookies

Progressive Web App (PWA)

- **Installable** to home screen on iOS and Android
- **Offline fallback** via service worker
- **Standalone full-screen experience** — no browser chrome

Aside

Product Summary · textaside.app (continued)

Tech Stack

Frontend: React + TypeScript, built with Vite
Backend: Node.js + Express
Database: PostgreSQL + pgvector extension (semantic search)
Production DB: Neon (serverless PostgreSQL)
ORM: Drizzle ORM with Drizzle-Zod schema validation
Styling: Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui component library
Routing: Wouter (client-side)
Data Fetching: TanStack Query v5
Real-time: WebSockets
Testing: Vitest + Supertest

Integrations

Twilio: Receiving SMS/MMS webhooks, sending verification codes, outbound notifications & search replies
OpenAI: text-embedding-3-small (1536-dim vectors) + GPT-4o-mini for conversational AI & intent classification
AWS S3: MMS image storage with signed URL retrieval — avoids Twilio URL expiry
Neon PostgreSQL: Production database with pgvector for semantic search
Microlink: Rich link preview data and OG fetching with bot-protection bypass
TMDB API: Enhanced IMDB movie & TV show link previews
Pendo: User analytics: 20+ profile fields tracking both web visits and SMS activity per user
Squarespace: Integration API: website signups trigger instant SMS welcome messages

Additional Features

URL Shortener /s/:code short links in SMS search results, domain-allowlisted to textaside.app
Admin Dashboard User management, stats, Pendo backfill, post enrichment, feedback & sweepstakes tools
Daily Cron Job Refreshes Pendo SMS activity metrics for all users at midnight
Automated Testing Vitest + Supertest covering auth, messages, boards, and admin endpoints

Design System

Primary color: #b95827 (warm orange)
Secondary color: #263d57 (dark navy blue)
Background: #faf6f3 (warm off-white)
Navigation: Mobile-first bottom tabs: Inbox · Boards · Search · Profile
Desktop: 72px slim icon rail — no sidebar, no hamburger menu
Aesthetic: "Apple Notes meets iMessage" — clean, warm, mobile-optimized

Deployment

Hosting: Replit Reserved VM (0.5 vCPU / 2 GiB RAM)

Production database: Neon PostgreSQL

Custom domain: textaside.app

Replit URL: context-micahhj.replit.app

Repl ID: c961059d-b0d6-4381-a263-d1e22ed9cec2

